Level 1, older clients

Level 1, older clients, 50 min

Warm up — 15 min

1. Footwork — 7 min, Reformer



Footwork: arches, parallel — **2 min, x10**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Arches on FB, par; Wrap the bar, press out; Knees track over 2nd toe



Footwork: calf stretch under the bar — **1 min, 3 slow holds**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Legs long, heels under FB; Hold 3 breaths, lift, repeat; Soft knees if tight



Footwork: heel lowers and lifts — **2 min, x10**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Legs long, balls of feet on FB; Lower heels under, lift high; Keep knees soft, not locked



Footwork: wide, turned out — **2 min, x10**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Heels wide, toes out (ER); Knees open over toes; Inner thighs zip on return

2. Bridge — 4 min, Reformer



Articulated bridge, feet on footbar — **2½ min, x6**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Imp, peel spine up (art); Hold at top, long thighs; Roll down bone by bone



Hinge bridge, feet on footbar — **1½ min, x8**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Arches on FB, hip wd; Lift hips as one piece; Hold, lower in one piece

3. Abs and supine arms — 4 min, Reformer



Chest press with light weights — **2 min, x10**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Lie on carr, feet on FB; Wts at chest, press up; Lower slow, elbows wide



Chest lift, feet on footbar — **2 min, x8**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Arches on FB, hands behind head; Exh, HNS curl up; Inh hold, Exh lower

Strength and tone — 19 min

4. Plank — 3 min, Mat



Forearm plank on the mat — **1½ min, 3 holds of 20 sec**
Forearms down, elbows under shoulders; Knees down or long legs; Breathe, hold, rest



Hands and knees hover — **1½ min, 3 holds of 10 sec**
Hands under shoulders, knees under hips; Hover knees 1 inch; Back flat, breathe, rest

5. Lower body — 5 min, Mat



Prone heel squeeze — **2½ min, x10**
Face down, knees wide, heels touch; Squeeze heels, Exh; Release slow



Inner thigh squeeze with magic circle — **2½ min, x10**
Lie on back, MC between knees; Squeeze, Exh; Release halfway

6. Upper back — 4 min, Mat



Prone W lifts — **2 min, x8**
Face down, arms in a W; Lift arms, scaps down; Lower slow, neck long



Seated rows with light weights — **2 min, x10**
Sit tall, small hinge forward; Pull elbows back; Scaps slide down

Second half

From minute 27. 2 equipment changes, 4 spring changes

Strength and tone, continued — 19 min

7. Upper front — 4 min, Reformer



Seated presentation — **2 min, x8**
Springs: Very light, 1 blue
Back to straps, elbows at sides; Palms up, open hands out; Reach forward, return slow



Shave the head — **2 min, x8**
Springs: Very light, 1 blue
Back to straps, hands behind head; Press up on diagonal; Elbows wide, slow return

8. Side body and rotation — 3 min, Reformer



Seated rotation with one strap — **1 min, x6 ea**
Springs: Very light, 1 blue
Side sit, both hands on 1 strap; Rotate away, arms at chest; Return slow, hips still



Mermaid: reach over the bar — **2 min, x4 ea**
Springs: Very light, 1 blue
Side sit, both hands on FB; Side bend toward FB; Breathe into side ribs

Functional — 11 min

9. Full body — 6 min, Reformer



Seated roll back with straps — **2½ min, x6**
Springs: Very light, 1 blue
Sit tall facing straps, hold straps; Exh, roll back to C-curve; Inh hold, Exh roll up tall



Standing hinge at the footbar — **1½ min, x6**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Stand, hands on FB; Walk back, hinge to flat back; Long spine, soft knees



Quadruped hold on the carriage — **2 min, 5 slow breaths x3**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Knees on carr, hands on FB; Long flat back; Tiny press back, hold, return

10. Back extension — 5 min, Reformer



Cat and cow on the carriage — **1½ min, x5**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Hands and knees, hands on FB; Round up, then lengthen; Slow with breath



Seated chest lift at the footbar — **1½ min, x6**
Springs: Light, 1 red
Sit facing FB, hands on FB; Lift chest forward and up; Long neck, return tall



Seated back extension with the straps — **2 min, x6**
Springs: Very light, 1 blue
Sit facing straps, arms forward; Pull arms past hips, lift chest; Return tall, slow

Lengthening — 5 min

11. Stretch — 5 min, Reformer



Seated breathing, arms circle — **1½ min, x5**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Sit tall on carr; Inh, arms float up; Exh, arms float down



Seated spine stretch on the carriage — **1½ min, x4**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Sit tall facing FB, legs wide; Hands on FB, round forward; Stack up tall



Figure 4 stretch, foot on footbar — **2 min, 3 breaths ea**
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
One foot on FB; Cross ankle over knee; Bend in a little, switch

Key. HNS Head and shoulders lifted; **FB** Footbar; **carr** Carriage; **par** Parallel legs; **ER** External rotation, turned out; **ea** Each side; **x** Repetitions, so x8 means 8 times; **Inh** Inhale; **Exh** Exhale; **scaps** Shoulder blades; **hip wd** Hip width apart; **art** Articulate, one bone at a time; **sec** Seconds; **MC** Magic circle. Springs: red heavy, blue medium, yellow light. Older clients start lighter. Start at the lighter load. Add spring only if form stays clean.